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Lab Space

Lab Space

Setting up your lab

A research lab is a sophisticated system, requiring both a user-friendly environment for participants and a carefully controlled integration of equipment. iMotions recommends the following general guidelines for optimal testing conditions.

SPACING

- Consistent and comfortable temperatures should be maintained within the participant testing space. Rooms should either have a built-in thermostat through the AC system or a standalone thermometer to ensure consistency of temperature.
- A procedure should be instituted to indicate to people outside of the room that testing is in progress (e.g. with a light or sign outside the door).
- A camera placed inside of the testing room for the moderator to observe from the adjoining room is needed to track participant progress (or a two-way mirror if a larger investment is available). Our team recommends Yi Technology cameras as an effective low cost option.
- A microphone can be installed in the observation room if participants will need instructions during the testing experience and the moderator does not want to enter the room and disrupt the experience.

SOUNDPROOFING

- The installation of sound panels will help protect outside noise from impacting the testing room.
- Weather stripping should be added to help close gaps between floors and doors, reducing noise disruption.
- Headphones should be used when more than one participant is running at a time to reduce distraction.

ELECTRICAL

- The room should contain multiple electrical outlets with easy plug access for powering equipment.

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- Line noise from electrical outlets or lighting can impact EEG signal quality, so it is best to ensure outlets are located a good distance away from participants' testing chairs.

LIGHTING

- Create ambient dispersed light in the testing room, by, for example, pointing a lamp against the wall behind the respondent. Overhead electrical lights may cause interference with signals.
- Ensure that no direct light enters into the eyes of the respondent as it can impact eye tracking signal quality. Direct light on the participant face can also obscure participant facial expressions.
- If the room is not an interior room isolated from sunlight, use blackout curtains to prevent light contamination.

FURNITURE

- A stationary chair without wheels and that does not spin is recommended to maintain participant position in front of the testing station.
- Desks with adjustable height to move up or down as necessary in conjunction with mobile stand placement are ideal for testing.

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